CalWORKs Program Guide: B. Employment Services Good Cause

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 10-020: WTW GOOD CAUSE
TITLE: B. EMPLOYMENT SERVICES GOOD CAUSE DETERMINATION

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE

Good Cause excuses a non-exempt Welfare-to-Work (WTW) participant from participation in assigned work, education, or training activities for a temporary period due to circumstances beyond their control under CDSS MPP EAS 42-713. Establishing good cause protects the participant from financial noncompliance sanctions.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & QUALIFYING REASONS

? Lack of Supportive Services: Good cause is mandatory when the County fails to provide necessary child care, transportation assistance, or required work-related ancillary payments. A participant cannot be penalized for non-participation if child care or transit was unavailable.

? Temporary Illness or Injury: Acute illness of the participant or a dependent child, verified by medical statement or reasonable customer declaration.

? Family Emergency & Crisis: Sudden death of a family member, severe domestic crisis, eviction, or homelessness.

? Breakdown of Transportation: Unexpected breakdown of primary transportation or temporary disruption of public transit services.

? Court Appearances & Legal Mandates: Required attendance at court hearings, custody proceedings, or probation appointments.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST

? Good Cause Interview: When a participant misses scheduled WTW hours, the caseworker must contact them by telephone or written notice to explore good cause before initiating noncompliance.

? Verification Standards: Accept reasonable customer explanations; third-party documentation should only be demanded when the stated reason is questionable.

? Barrier Removal: Immediately resolve the underlying barrier (e.g., re-authorize bus passes or arrange child care) to facilitate re-engagement.